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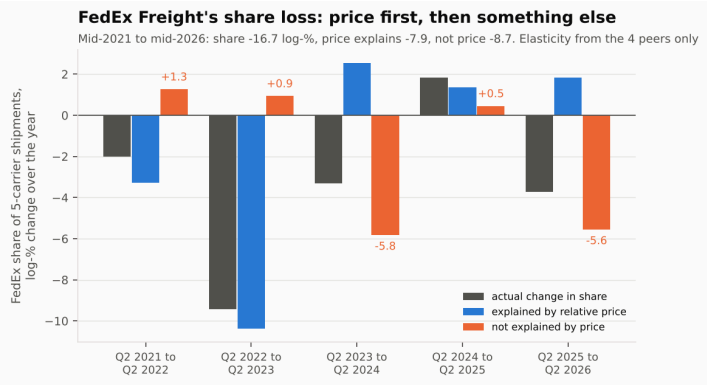
Data as of Oct 23, 2026 · public data only

Market or share? What explains FedEx Freight's lost volume

FedEx Freight has lost about a sixth of its share of the five largest public LTL carriers' shipments since mid-2021. I estimated how shipment share responds to relative price using its four public competitors only, applied it to FedEx out of sample, and locked forecasts of every carrier's next quarter before any of them report. Methods were pre-registered (committed before fitting).

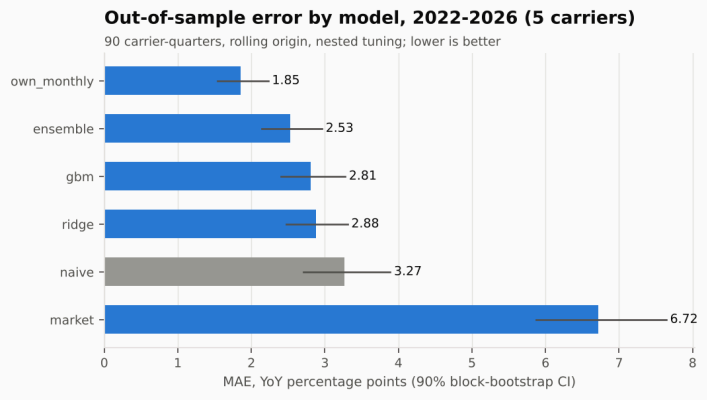
-16.7	**-7.9**	**-8.7**	**-6.0%**
FedEx share of 5-carrier shipments, mid-2021 to mid-2026 (log-%)	explained by FedEx's relative price	not price: the Yellow year and the spin-off year	locked forecast, FedEx shipments/day Jun-Sep 2026 (reports Oct 29)

1. How much of the share loss is price?



- **Share-price elasticity 0.65** within the year, 0.97 with one lag (peers only, carrier fixed effects; 95% CI -0.99 to -0.31). Placebo with prices shuffled within carrier: p = 0.015. Robust to ex-fuel prices and quarter fixed effects; leave-one-carrier-out beats no-change for 3 of 4.
- **2022-23:** FedEx raised relative price ~10%; price explains essentially all of that year's share loss (yield-first).
- **2023-24 and 2025-26:** share fell -5.8 and -5.6 log-points beyond price, while FedEx's relative price was falling. Peers absorbed Yellow's customers; then the spin-off and bundle unwinding. These are retention questions.

2. Forecasts made before the answers exist

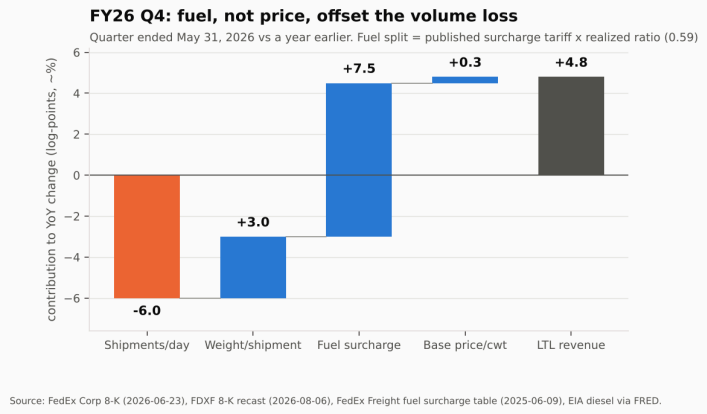


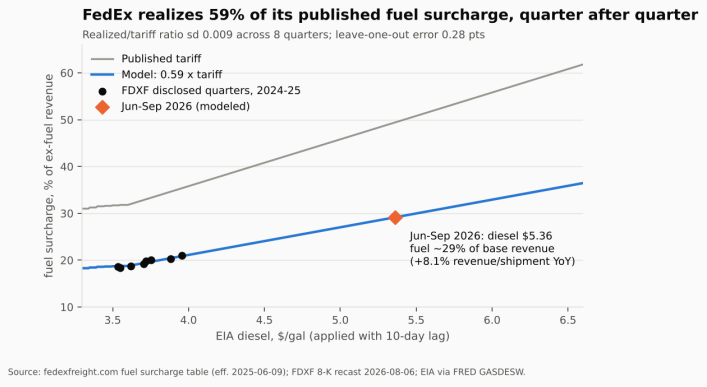
Carrier	Pre-registered	80% interval	ML ensemble
FDX Jun-Sep 2026	-6.0%	-11.2 to -2.0	-4.7%
ODFL Q3 2026	-2.4%	-3.8 to -0.9	-2.8%
SAIA Q3 2026	+0.9%	-0.4 to +2.5	+2.0%
XPO Q3 2026	+5.5%	+4.2 to +7.1	+3.6%
ARCB Q3 2026	-3.7%	-5.1 to -2.2	-3.5%

SHA-256 256eee154fe9… in commit e4e6b9d. BofA's estimate for FedEx's Sept quarter: -3.0%.

- 90 carrier-quarters, 36 issue dates, rolling origin, nested tuning, features gated by EDGAR filing dates.
- Own intra-quarter data cuts error 43% vs naive (Diebold-Mariano p = 0.001). ML improves 12 to 22%, **not significant** (p = 0.23). For FedEx alone nothing beats naive, so with FedEx's daily data the value is in longer horizons and account-level share.

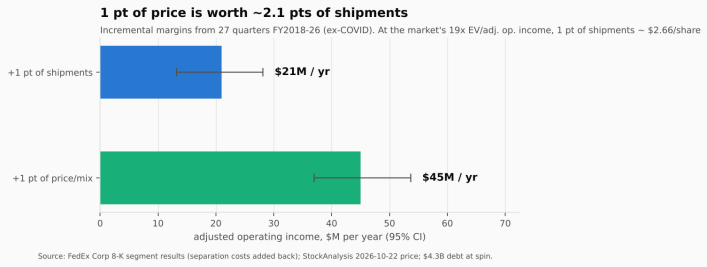
3. Is pricing holding, or is it fuel?

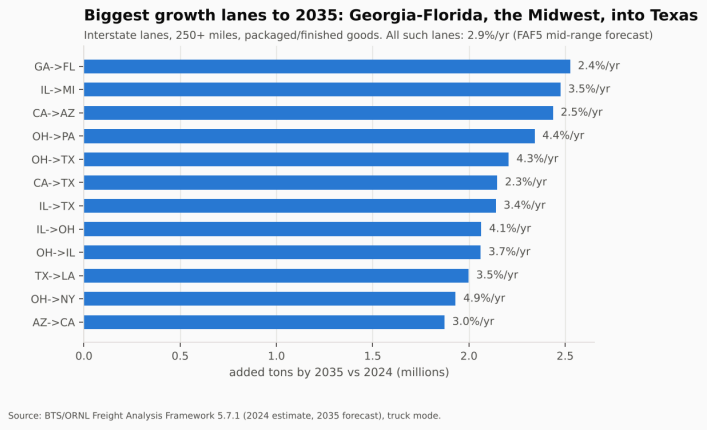




- FedEx collects **0.59x** its published fuel surcharge (sd 0.009, 8 quarters). FY26 Q4 base revenue/cwt +0.3% (management: "slight decline"); weight-adjusted price +2.1% to +2.7%. At EIA's 2027 diesel, fuel alone takes 7.7% off revenue per shipment.

4. What a point is worth, and where freight grows





Revenue from volume adds 24¢ of operating income per dollar, price/mix 51¢ (27 quarters). One point of shipments is about $21M a year, ~$2.66 a share at ~19x. LTL-type freight on 250+ mile interstate lanes grows 2.9%/yr to 2035 in FAF5.

5. What I would build with FedEx Freight's data

Retention	Account-level share early warning: expected weekly shipments per account, drift flags ranked by volume at risk, starting with formerly bundled accounts. Evaluated the same way: pre-registered, rolling-origin, vs naive.
Pricing	Segment-level price response (lane, size, commodity) from renewals and GRIs; the 2.1:1 price-volume exchange rate as guardrail.
Revenue integrity	Predicted shipment density vs dimensioner reads under density-based NMFC classes; inspect the largest expected differences first.
Fuel	Realized-to-tariff fuel ratio by contract, ahead of falling diesel.

`Tested: pre-registration and deviations log in ds/; point-in-time features; no-look-ahead tests; Diebold-Mariano (HLN); block bootstrap; conformal intervals with measured coverage; placebo and leave-one-carrier-out checks; 31 automated tests. Negative results reported. Sources: SEC EDGAR (FedEx, FDXF, ODFL, SAIA, XPO, ARCB), FRED, BTS/ORNL FAF5.7.1, EIA, fedexfreight.com fuel table. All charts generated in Python. Code: github.com/kstc707/job-search. Independent work; not affiliated with FedEx; not investment advice.`